My ex-wife Tenielle was actually one of only two people who came to visit me at Harmony Clinic. My manager Donné was the other one. I had to apologise to Tenielle for all the heartache and shit I had caused her. Tenielle said to me that had we still been married, she would gladly have gone through the whole thing with me.

By then Tenielle and I had been divorced for about six months, and I'd only seen her a couple of times since, when we'd bumped into each other by chance. She was still angry with me, which is understandable, but she still came to see me. It was part of the clinic's programme to have those you have hurt come and visit so that you could apologise to them.

Still, Tenielle didn't *have* to come. It was an emotional experience for both of us. I wasn't just saying sorry to her, I was really speaking from my heart. And that – for me at least – was a very traumatic experience. I still love her, and every time I see her it hits me in the chest, because I was besotted with her at one stage. I couldn't even think straight or hit a cricket ball.

I was just as emotional with Donné. Donné couldn't even speak to me – she was too emotional. So she wrote me a letter and burst out crying before she could even finish reading it. There were more than a few tears in my eyes too. I also asked Donné to clear all the alcohol out of my house and to pass the message on to all the cricket teams I played for that all alcohol was to be removed from the mini-bar of any hotel room I was staying in. But yes, those were two very stressful sessions.

My folks never visited me. I have no idea why … I haven't asked them. I guess it's sad in a way, but we've never had the deep connection other families may have. I suppose part of the reason is that I've never spent much time with them as an adult. I started playing professional cricket at 16 and I've been on the road for 21-odd years now. That's more than half my life. We see each other when I get a bit of time off, but my parents are also divorced and have lived separate lives for the past 10 years.

My mom's always been very affectionate and still speaks to me like I'm her 10-year-old boy, but I think most mothers are similar. It's not as if I don't show emotion when I see my parents. Wine always brings out emotion. Whenever we sit down and share a few glasses of wine, and talk about things dear to my heart, it always brings out all these emotions in me and I invariably start crying.